



Where synthetic biology meets art

MICROBIAL PAINTING WORKSHOP

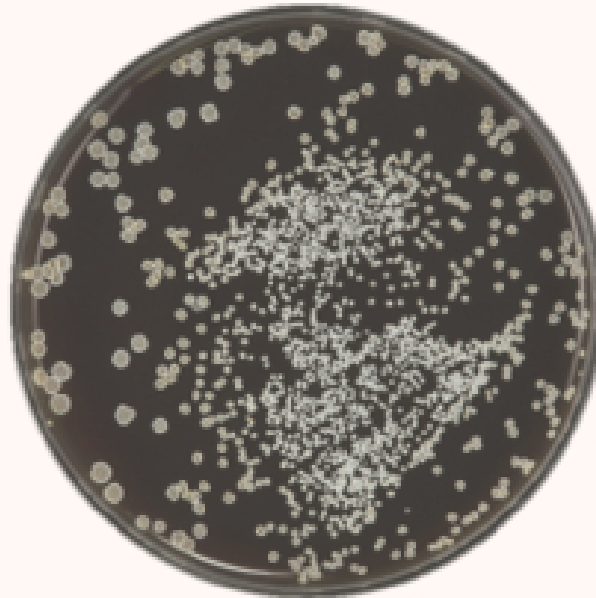
Hosted by the McGill iGEM Team

MAY - JUNE



WHAT IS THE WORKSHOP?

A hands-on activity where students will use safe engineered bacteria to create artwork on agar plates.



Students will learn how microbes can be engineered to produce color and the intersectionality of art and science!

WHAT THE SCHOOL/TEACHER NEEDS TO PROVIDE

- A classroom or lab space
- Projector

Note: All scientific materials (plates, cultures, PPE, tools) are provided by the iGEM team

STUDENTS WILL LEARN TO:

- What synthetic biology is
- How microbes can be engineered
- How gene expression produces color
- Basic biosafety and sterile lab techniques

KNOW

- Cells can be programmed like living machines
- DNA controls visible traits
- Engineering life comes with ethical responsibilities
- Concept of fluorescence

UNDERSTAND

- Handle agar plates safely
- Use sterile swabs
- Plan and design microbial artwork
- Reflect on ethical implications of engineering life

DO

IMPORTANCE OF THIS WORKSHOP

- Connects directly to Quebec education program (QEP) competencies
- Builds scientific literacy, creativity, and critical thinking
- Makes synthetic biology accessible, safe, and exciting



Duration: 50-60 minutes
Best for: Grades 8-10
Offered: May-June
Hosted by: McGill iGEM Team



CONTACTS

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